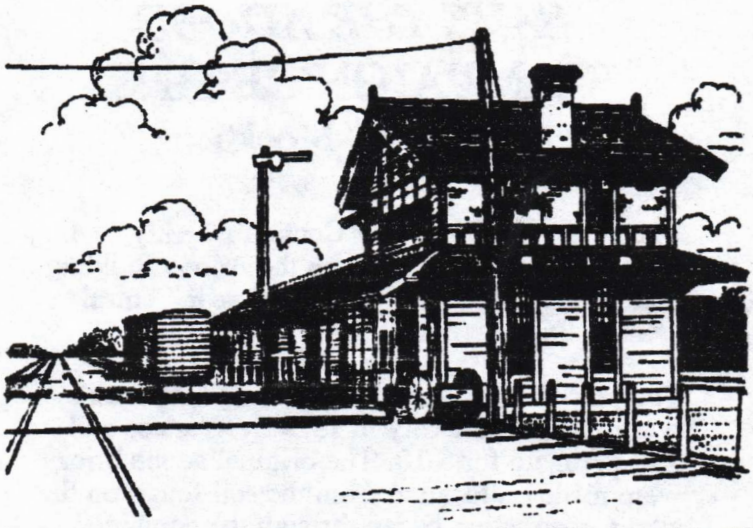
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



EXPERIENCES WITH THE PEACE CORPS IN HUNGARY

The November Meeting

Experiences of a Peace Corps Volunteer in Hungary Our November 5, 1995, meeting will feature Trudi Herrero Odbert, who will describe her recent experiences as a Peace Corps Volunteer in Veszprem, Hungary.

Trudi Herrero Odbert moved to Mtn. View with her parents in 1921. Her father operated Herrero's Market at the corner of View and El Camino for many years. She attended grade school and High School in Mountain View. She married a career navy Meteorological Officer, Jack Odbert, and lived the life of a naval wife for 28 years. They had duty stations on both coasts, in Alaska and overseas. When they retired from the Navy, Trudi really went to work, attending Foothill College, San Jose State, and eventually obtaining a Masters Degree in Education from Stanford University. She taught at Gunn High School for thirteen years, retired, did some traveling, signed up for the Peace Corps, and spent two years at the University at Veszprem, Hungary, teaching teachers to teach English.

(continued in next column)

BARBECUE SOCIAL & RAFFLE

The August Meeting

On Sunday, August 13, 1995, The Mountain View Historical Association held its ***"Second Annual Barbecue Social."*** You will find inside a listing of the fine businesses that contributed to the success of the event through the donation of food and raffle prizes. The weather was perfect, the food was delicious, the raffle fun, and the fellowship outstanding. The Executive Committee has endorsed continuance of the "Annual Barbecue Social" for the first Sunday in August. Mark you calendars now for August 4, 1996, for the ***"Third Annual Barbecue Social."***

Trudi has a big family, including 4 daughters, 10 grandchildren, and 8 great grandchildren, all living in California.

With her lifetime of travel, family and teaching experience, Trudi is extremely well qualified to bring us some insights into the times and people of a troubled part of the world.

SAVE THE ADOBE CAMPAIGN BEGINS

By Eva G. Mockbee

The Mountain View City Council recently announced plans to demolish the Adobe Building located at 157 Moffett Boulevard near Central Central Express Way.

The property on which the building now stands was deeded to the City in 1929 by Wallace and Alice Angelo for $ 10. The original adobe bricks were made on location from the soil found on the site. Construction began through the combined efforts of the Junior Chamber of Commerce and the WPA. It was presented to the City in 1934.

Through the 30's, 40's, 50's, 60's and the early 70's, the adobe served as a community facility, a place for meetings of the American Legion, USO, Dance Classes, Senior Nutrition Program, Service Men's Hospitality Room and the Eagles's Shack, a teen center - to name a few. In 1987, plans for renovation were proposed, including removal of the adjacent water tower to allow for additional parking spaces. The costs of upgrading the facility were deemed too high and the facility was closed, its future much in doubt.

When the Mountain View Historical Association was informed that the Adobe might be demolished, a letter was sent to the City Council, requesting a reasonable amount of time to study costs of renovation, plans for fundraising and exploration for use of the Adobe as a community meeting hall. Presently, Mountain View lacks a suitable locale for community groups and local clubs to hold meetings or social events.

The City Council granted the Mountain View Historical Association a three month period to explore opportunities for utilization of the Adobe and sources for fundraising. The study will include the development of a proposal to declare the building a historical landmark.

Currently, the City of Mountain View lacks an ordinance regarding designation of historical buildings; a committee, appointed by President Ralph Faravelli is now at work obtaining information from neighboring communities relating to this endeavor.

The Mountain View Historical Association is enlisting the support of the membership, local business, community groups and concerned citizens in their efforts to SAVE THE ADOBE, Mountain View's last remaining, public historical building.

The October, 1994, issue of the Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter contained an article, "The Adobe Building", by Carol Fischer, giving some of the history of the building.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING

September 30, 1995

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met at 10:00AM, Saturday, September 30, 1995, at the Mountain View Library. Details of the Membership and Treasurer reports are provided elsewhere in this Newsletter. Topics for future meetings were discussed. (Suggestions from the membership would be welcome.) The resignations of Memorials Chairman Ann Taylor, and Social Activities Chairman Margaret Vidovich were accepted with regret.

The Executive Committee unanimously endorsed that the Association sponsor and support a plan to save the Adobe Building. You will find an article supporting and explaining this action elsewhere in this Newsletter.

The expansion of the Pioneer Room was noted. New display cases and exhibits are in place. The plans for the Pioneer Room in the new Library were also discussed.

The complete minutes of the meetings of the Executive Committee are available to any member of the Association from either the Secretary or the Newsletter Editor.

NETTIE MARIA STEVENS
Biologist and Geneticist
Reported by Loretta M. Jackson

Rosamond Bacon, a longtime resident of Stanford, recently brought Nettie Stevens to my attention. Nettie, along with her librarian sister, Emma Stevens, and her father Ephraim Stevens lived on a prune and apricot farm here in Mountain View. Nettie was the first one to arrive, leaving Vermont for California in 1896 to get her education at Stanford. Her father and sister came out to visit her, fell in love with the area and decided to relocate.

Nettie Stevens became a scientist in a time when many colleges didn't even allow women to take any science courses because they felt the work would be too hard and potentially damaging to a woman's mental and physical health. After receiving her A.M. Degree at Stanford in 1900 Nettie Stevens got her first paper, of the forty she would eventually produce, published.

Oliver Peebles Jenkins and Frank McFarland are probably the professors that led Dr. Stevens to her work in cytological research. Her interest in nucleus and chromosomes eventually led her to Bryn Mawr where she worked with Thomas H. Morgan. Her most significant paper was published in 1905 and identified the specific chromosome that determines sex. This major breakthrough was discovered simultaneously by another scientist, E.B. Wilson, who published his paper almost in the same week. Both scientists had great respect for each other and referred to each other's work as proof of their own.

This discovery was considered quite radical and took some years to be accepted by the scientific community. Sadly, by the time it was accepted, Nettie Maria Stevens died of breast cancer at only 51, and most science books credit Wilson with the discovery rather than both of them. Many of the articles I found described Dr. Stevens as scholarly, quiet, earnest and unassuming and her scientific papers were known for their clarity and brevity. Many felt that her untimely death prevented her from receiving the Nobel Prize that her future research would have earned.

IN MEMORIUM

Elda Frederickson Black, 84, died earlier this year. She attended local schools and then taught 28 years in the Mountain View Elementary School District and was a well-known pianist and organist.

Anna Knapp Fitz, 82, of Los Altos, was a long-time member and supporter of the Historical Association, and a graduate of Mountain View High School. In later life she did many paintings and studied sculpture. Her oil paintings and sculptured heads were based on our local area's historical people and scenes and were used to help children especially, visualize the past.

Angelo Semino, 99, was born in Mountain View, son of Italian parents. Their farm was the site later of Mayfield Mall where there is a commemorative plaque for the family. Mr. Semino was a Stanford graduate and a mechanical engineer and served as Historical Association president 1980-1982.

Ross Spencer, 80, died in August. A native son, he was associated with Sterling Lumber Company.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
Noted by Barbara Kinchen

100 Years ago (1985): Female bicycle riders were called bloomer girls.

"The school trustees and the principal have been gunning for woodpeckers who infest the school house."

"French Dave" was sentenced to 15 days in the County jail by Judge Frank Beverly for disturbing the peace.

An early morning fire destroyed seven buildings on the East side of Castro Street between Villa and Front (now Evelyn) Streets. The bucket brigade could not stop the flames and the whole block would have been lost if there had been a wind. All persons sleeping in the buildings escaped and some household goods and stock-in-trade were saved. McDonald and Burke, the blacksmiths, were back to work within hours under a temporary shed roof but it took three days for Mr. Guth to erect a rough shack with dirt floor and start selling drinks. Within one month new structures housed the restaurant, blacksmiths, tinner, carriage painter, barber, saloon and fruit store.

Mountain View Cyclers Club gave a smoker for members and guests. Entertainment consisted of card playing, vocal and instrumental music, food, speeches, followed by "impromptu high jinks by some of the less dignified members."

It was reported that Mrs. Jones received $3,703.50 from the New York Life Insurance Company after the recent death of her husband, Dr Caleb Valentine Jones, Mountain View physician. An ad appears in the same issue of the Mountain View Register reading, "Money to Loan - Inquire of Mrs. C.V. Jones."

75 Years Ago (1920): Powell Brothers Grocery advertised a special sale offering 5% off on purchase of half dozen quantities, 10% off in dozen quantities and 10 extra S & H Green Stamps free with a purchase over 50¢. And how about these prices? Old Dutch Cleanser 10¢, 2 cans tomato soup 15¢, 10 pound can Karo Syrup 99¢.

"We could stand the man who knows it all if he didn't insist on telling it all."

Hope Street is to be paved from curb to curb for its entire length.

Turlock Post of the American Legion has been named after a former Mountain View boy, Rex Ish. Killed in France in 1918, he was the first young man to enlist in Turlock. An American Legion Post is being organized in Mountain View.

Mr. Fahey of Sunnyvale has bought the old Rengstorff Landing and 80 adjoining acres, intending to revive shipping from that location. He already brought in several boatloads of hay for lowland dairymen and would like to have cargo to take out on return trips. Interest is being shown in establishing a deep-water port at Jagel's Landing.

Firemen have 143 hand fire extinguishers to sell in order to win a "chemical fire engine" which can be mounted on a regular touring car chassis.

A tremendous crop of sugar beets is being harvested and an average of five carloads a day shipped from the train station. Farmers report yields of 30 tons per acre, selling for $14 per ton.

The part of Dr. Marsh in Fran Bacon's new play "Five O'clock" is based on the late Dr T.B. Ross of Mountain View, who "on his deathbed wrote a prescription that saved the life of a patient."

50 Years Ago (1945): Mountain View Adventist Academy celebrated its 25th anniversary.

Zane Grey's West of the Pecos, starring Bob Mitchum, was showing at the Mountain View Theatre.

Sea Scout Ship 65, sponsored by our local firemen, sails out of Palo Alto harbor.

Santa Clara County Tuberculosis Association's X-ray trailer will be in town for one day. Free chest X-rays are available to anyone age 18 and over. The sale of Christmas seals pays for this service.

Mancini Motors has both new and used Army trucks for sale.

A $25 Victory Bond was won by Knight's Pharmacy for placing first in the Chamber of Commerce holiday store window decorating contest.

Customers are urged to promptly return empty milk bottles to help ease the container shortage.

On a recent Saturday between 11 a.m. and 12 noon, 1,213 cars were counted at Castro Street and El Camino Real, with 657 passing on the highway and 556 coming in or out of the city. Police Chief Excell says these figures indicate that the Highway Commission should install stop and go lights at that intersection.

Bank of America is getting ready to build on the north east corner of Castro and Dana Streets. (Printers Inc. Bookstore location). Dr. Bynum's little office, lately occupied by Lawson and Shary, and the old home housing Murray Beauty Parlor have been moved elsewhere in preparation.

NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM

Reported by Barbara Kinchen

From Mary Ann Meek Buswell - Photo taken in 1946 of Girl Scout Troop #3 at high school pool.

From Joe Sweeney -"Memories of Los Altos", a 1982 booklet compiled by Joe Salameda.

From Peggy Mylrea Matthews and the Estate of Ed "Bud" Mylrea - A collection of snapshots and photos including grammar school class pictures, Macon, Moffett Field blimp, Perry Askam, Max Bellew and the 1933 grammar school graduation program and a 1938 high school diploma.

From John Mandel - Information from his research in Santa Clara County Patent Books, showing names of those receiving grants from California and the Federal Government, type of grant (School Land, Railroad Land, Sale of Public Land, Military Bounty Rights, etc.), and location. Many show dates in the 1860s and 1870s.

ITEMS ON DISPLAY IN THE PIONEER ROOM

On display in the expanded Pioneer Room are items from the Campbell Family Collection. These include pictures, an ornate photo album, autograph books from around 1900 and a cookbook. There are also pictures and memorabilia from Mountain View High School. Framed pictures will soon be in place on the walls.

BARBECUE SOCIAL DONATIONS

The Mountain View Historical Association is grateful to the following businesses whose generosity helped make the annual Barbecue a great success:

Business	Address	Donation

BABECUE SUPPLIES

Costco	100 No. Rengstorff	Hamburgers
Safeway	1750 Miramonte	Burger buns
Lucky's	580 No. Rengstorff	Salad fixings
Nob Hill	1350 Grant Rd.	Condiments
Safeway	2580 California	Apple Pies

RAFFLE PRIZES

Michael's Shoreline 2960 Shoreline	2 Lunches
Pure Water 1762 Miramonte	40 gals. water
Lucky's 715 E. El Camino	2 Gift Cert.
Image Makers Hair Salon 1728 Miramonte	Gift Certificate
String's Italian Rest. 1049 El Monte	Gift Certificate
Harry's Hofbrau 399 W. El Camino	4 Dinners
Baskin-Robbins 1249 W. El Camino	2 Sundaes + 1 lb. IceCream
Baskin Robbins 703 E. El Camino	Gift Certificate
Starbuck's Coffee 1041 El Monte	3 lb. Coffee
One Hour Photo 4598 El Camino, Los Altos	Camera

TREASURER'S REPORT

June 1995 - August 1995

As Reported by June de Larios

Balance 5/31/95		**$5864.59**
Income		
Dues	$232.00	
Donations	25.00	
Barbecue Soc.	932.00	
Total Income		$1189.00
Expense		
Pioneer Room	$330.15	
Barbecue Soc	213.96	
Newsletter	355.00	
Administration	33.07	
Total Expense		$ 932.18
Balance 8/31/95		**$6121.41**

BARBECUE SOCIAL FINANCIAL REPORT

August 13, 1995

Reported by Edna Thompson

Receipts:		
81 persons @ $8.00		$648.00
Raffle Tickets		252.00
Food Donations		189.00
Total Receipts		$1089.00
Expenses:		
Flyers, Postage, PA, Park Rental	$287.30	
Cost of Food	233.19	
Total Expenses		$ 520.49
Net Profit - Barbecue Social		**$ 568.51**

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

As of September 30, 1995

Reported by Edna Thompson

A list of all members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available from the Chair of the Membership Committee or from the Newsletter Editor.

Dues are $7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Below is a tally by class of membership, and a list of the new members.

Life Members	31
Honored Member	1
Special Members	3
Family Memberships	49
Individual Members	117

Total Memberships	201
Total Members	250

New Members (Since the last Newsletter)

New Life Members

Joe Kleitman

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD

President	Ralph Faravelli
Vice President & Program	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	JuneDeLarios
Past President	Wally Erichsen
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Publicity	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorials/Rememberances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Albert Jehning
Social Activities	Wally Erichsen

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics, submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for

Life Members

(Those marked * are new life members in 1995)

Lorena Anderson*
Dena K. Bonnell*
Reynolds Camp*
Cliff Del Carlo
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli*
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa*
Marion Grimm*
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
DeWitt Hogle*
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
John W. Kirby*
Joe Kleitman*
Helen Shearer Krogh
Eva Mockbee*
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn*
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Martin J. Spangler*
Honor Spitz
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson*
John Viscovich*
Bill Wissell

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Regular Meeting

Sunday, November 5, 1995

2:00 PM

Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speaker

Experiences With the Peace Corps in Hungary

Trudi Herrero Odbert

Peace Corps Volunteer

MEMBERSHIP

Any person who signifies their interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS The aims of this Association are: To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area: to preserve historic objects and places. To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

_____

TELEPHONE _____

NEW ___ RENEWAL ___ Regular Membership $7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr - Life Membership $100.00
Make Check Payable and mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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